

Art: Photography

(A Level, AQA)

This course introduces you to a variety of approaches when working with photographic images including portraiture, landscape, still life and experimental imagery. You will look at photography in a historical context and consider how it has developed over time informing contemporary practice and current trends.

The course is well resourced, including having a fully working darkroom and studio, and a full time technician. The course starts going back to the basics of photography to develop stronger skills when considering perspective, movement, composition, rule of thirds, depth of field and the elements of art.

You will explore the different styles, genres, processes and techniques available to the photographer and start to plan what area of photography you will like to investigate independently including film. You are taught how to work with digital and film SLR cameras taking shoots on location and in the studio. You will also learn how to manipulate images using Photoshop and darkroom derivatives to help you achieve more original, experimental, and skilful outcomes.

Entry Requirements: GCSE Grade 4 in Photography. Good DSLR camera skills are essential, and you will need to develop these skills alongside digital editing using Apple Mac computer software. If you have not taken Photography at GCSE you will be expected to show work of the expected level before coming to the induction session and starting the course.

Course Content

Unit	%	When?	Content
Component 1: Personal Investigation	60%	September to December (Year 1)	Elements Project: the theme of the first project is based on the elements of art and will be given to you during the induction day, so you have the summer to start developing your work. Over the first term you will have teacher led lessons developing photographic skills, leading into an independent project over term two taking ideas and themes from this Elements project.
		January (Year 1) to January (Year 2)	Personal Investigation: your choice of theme Inspiration Book – finding inspiration from a range of sources - learning how to research, analyse and respond to art and photography. Responding and experimenting with ideas – developing skills Trip to Art Galleries – recording experiences to inspire your own project. Essay – 1000-3000 word essay that makes links with your own art and shows critical and contextual understanding. Practical project resulting in final outcomes – you will start the main project in September of Year 2.
Component 2: Externally Set Assignment	40%	February to May (Year 2)	Choose from eight given starting points from exam board. Preparation work over three months to develop ideas. Fifteen hours (three days) of supervised sessions to complete final outcome. All work is assessed as a whole project for final grade.

Career Links

It is especially appropriate for students seeking to go on to an Art Foundation course or for those who wish to study degree courses in Photography, Media and Film Production, Photojournalism, or careers in Marketing, Advertising, Publishing and in the Film Industry.

For more information please contact Mr Ray